AGENTWISE · FREE GUIDE

Argue With Your AI.

25 prompts that make your AI assistant push back, test your thinking and stop agreeing with everything you say.

BUILD IT. AUTOMATE IT. GROW IT.

START HERE

Your AI agrees with you too easily.

Ask an AI assistant "is this a good idea?" and it will usually find reasons to say yes. That feels helpful. It is the least useful thing it can do.

The most useful answers come when you ask it to disagree, to check and to choose. This guide gives you 25 prompts that do that. Copy one, fill in the brackets, paste it into any AI chat tool.

New to AI? Start here, 3 minutes.

1. Open any AI chat tool, for example ChatGPT or Gemini. The free version is enough.
2. Copy the setup line on the next page and paste it in.
3. Copy prompt 01, replace the words in [brackets] with your own, and send it.

How to use this guide

- **Brackets are yours.** Everything in [brackets] is a blank for your details. The more specific you are, the better the answer.
- **One prompt at a time.** Pick the one that fits today's problem. You do not need all 25.
- **Answer its questions.** Some prompts make the AI ask you things. That is the point.
- **You decide.** The AI gives you a harder look at your thinking. The decision stays with you.

What is inside

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE IT WHEN
Decisions	01 to 05	When you are about to commit to something
Ideas and plans	06 to 10	When you have an idea and want it tested, not praised
Writing and messages	11 to 15	When the words matter
Learning	16 to 20	When you want to understand, not just read
Work and money	21 to 25	When time and price are on the line

THE METHOD

Three moves and one setup line.

Every prompt in this guide is one of three moves. Once you know them, you can write your own.

Move 1: Challenge

Ask it to argue against you. "Give the strongest reasons I could be wrong."

Move 2: Check

Ask it to test what you said. "List my assumptions and mark which are untested."

Move 3: Choose

Ask it to commit. "Say which you would pick in my position, and what would change your mind."

The setup line

Paste this once at the start of a chat. It changes how the assistant answers for the rest of the conversation.

```
For this chat: do not agree with me to be polite. If I am wrong, say so and say why. If you are unsure, say you are unsure. Ask me one question when you need more information. Keep answers under 200 words unless I ask for more.
```

The follow-up that works after any answer

```
What are you least sure about in that answer, and how could I check it?
```

What a good answer looks like. It names something specific you had not thought of. It tells you what to check. It commits to a view and says what would change it. If the answer only praises you, send the setup line again and repeat the prompt.

PROMPTS 01 TO 05

Decisions

When you are about to commit to something.

01. The Devil's Advocate

Use it before any decision you already feel sure about.

```
I am about to decide: [decision]. My reasons: [reasons]. Argue against it as strongly as you honestly can. Give the 3 strongest reasons I could be wrong, the one fact that would change your mind, and what I should check before I commit. Do not soften it.
```

02. The Pre-Mortem

Use it before you start a plan or project.

```
Imagine it is 6 months from now and [plan] has failed. Write the 5 most likely reasons it failed, most likely first. For each, give one early warning sign and one cheap step I can take this week to lower the risk.
```

03. The Missing Option

Use it when you are stuck between two choices.

```
I am choosing between [A] and [B] for [goal]. Before you compare them, list 3 options I have not considered, including doing nothing. Then say which you would pick in my position and what you would need to know to be sure.
```

04. The Second Opinion

Use it on advice from a person, an article or another AI answer.

```
Here is advice I received: [paste]. My situation: [situation]. Act as an independent second opinion. Say what is sound, what is questionable, what is missing, and which questions I should ask the person who gave it.
```

05. The Regret Test

Use it for personal or career choices.

```
Decision: [decision]. Describe how I might feel about each choice in 1 week, 1 year and 5 years. Say which of my fears are short-term discomfort and which are lasting cost. End with the one question I am avoiding.
```

PROMPTS 06 TO 10

Ideas and plans

When you have an idea and want it tested, not praised.

06. The Hole Finder

Use it on any plan before you show it to people.

```
Here is my plan: [paste]. Find the holes. List every assumption I am making, mark each as tested or untested, and rank the untested ones by how badly they would hurt if wrong.
```

07. The First Customer

Use it before you build or sell anything.

```
My idea: [idea]. Play a sceptical customer who has [problem] and has been let down before. Ask me the 7 hardest questions you would need answered before paying. Ask one at a time and wait for my answer. At the end, tell me where I was unconvincing.
```

08. The Cheapest Test

Use it when you believe something about customers but have not checked.

```
I believe [belief]. Design 3 ways to test it in under 7 days with under [budget]. For each: what I do, what result would prove me wrong, and what I do next.
```

09. The Simplifier

Use it when the plan keeps growing.

```
Here is what I plan to build or do: [paste]. Cut it to the smallest version that still delivers [core result]. Tell me what you removed and why I will not miss it yet.
```

10. The Competitor's View

Use it to see your offer from the other side.

```
You are [competitor or alternative]. Explain honestly why customers choose you over [my offer]. Then tell me the one thing you would worry about if I did it well.
```

PROMPTS 11 TO 15

Writing and messages

When the words matter.

11. The Tough Editor

Use it on anything longer than a paragraph.

```
Edit this for a busy reader: [paste]. First tell me in one sentence what you think my main point is. If you got it wrong, the problem is my writing. Then cut 30%, flag any claim without proof, and show the revised version.
```

12. The Cold Reader

Use it on a post, a page or an email to a stranger.

```
Read this as someone who has never heard of me: [paste]. Tell me what you understood after the first 2 sentences, where you lost interest, what you did not believe, and what you would do next.
```

13. The Tone Check

Use it before you send a sensitive message.

```
Here is a message I am about to send to [who]: [paste]. How could it be misread? Give the most negative reasonable reading, then a version that keeps my point and removes that risk.
```

14. The Objection Finder

Use it on an offer, a proposal or a pitch.

```
Here is my offer: [paste]. List the 5 objections the reader will have and will not say out loud. For each, write one honest sentence I could add to answer it.
```

15. The Plain English Pass

Use it when you suspect you sound clever and unclear.

```
Rewrite this so a 14-year-old could explain it back: [paste]. Keep every fact. List the jargon you removed and any place where I was vague because I was unsure.
```

PROMPTS 16 TO 20

Learning

When you want to understand, not just read.

16. The Examiner

Use it after you study something.

```
I am learning [topic]. Ask me 5 questions that start easy and get harder, one at a time. After each answer, tell me what was right, what was wrong and why. At the end, list my 3 weakest points and what to study next.
```

17. The Teach-Back

Use it to find what you only half understand.

```
I will explain [topic] in my own words: [explanation]. Correct what is wrong, fill in what is missing, and tell me which part shows I only half understand it.
```

18. The Misconception Hunter

Use it at the start of a new subject.

```
What are the 5 most common things people get wrong about [topic]? For each, say why the wrong idea is tempting and how I can check which is true.
```

19. The Other Side

Use it on a view you disagree with.

```
Give me the strongest case for [view I disagree with], as its best defenders would make it. Then tell me which parts of my own view hold up and which do not.
```

20. The 20-Hour Plan

Use it before you start learning a skill.

```
I want to be useful at [skill] after 20 hours of practice. Here is my plan: [plan, or 'none yet']. Challenge it. Tell me what to skip, what to practise first, and how I will know I am improving.
```

PROMPTS 21 TO 25

Work and money

When time and price are on the line.

21. The Negotiation Partner

Use it before a pay, price or deadline conversation.

```
I am about to negotiate [what] with [who]. Play them. Push back the way they realistically would. After 5 exchanges, stop and tell me where I gave away too much and what I could say instead.
```

22. The Priority Cutter

Use it on Monday morning.

```
Here is everything on my list this week: [paste]. My one goal this month: [goal]. Tell me what to drop, what to delay and what to do first. Push back if my list does not match my goal.
```

23. The Price Challenger

Use it when you set or change a price.

```
I charge [price] for [offer] to [customer]. Argue that I am too cheap, then that I am too expensive. Tell me what evidence would settle it and how I could get that evidence this week.
```

24. The Meeting Killer

Use it before you send a calendar invite.

```
Here is a meeting I plan to hold: [purpose, people, length]. Argue that it should be an email, a document or nothing. If it survives, give a 3-point agenda and the decision it must end with.
```

25. The Honest Review

Use it on finished work before anyone else sees it.

```
Here is my work: [paste]. Review it the way a fair but demanding expert in [field] would. Give 3 strengths, 3 weaknesses and the one change with the biggest effect. Do not praise it to be polite.
```

KEEP GOING

Five mistakes, and a 10-minute habit.

MISTAKE	WHAT TO DO INSTEAD
Asking "is this good?"	Ask "what is wrong with this?" You get praise for the first and help from the second.
Giving no context	Say who you are, who it is for and what you want to happen. Two sentences are enough.
Accepting the first answer	Send the follow-up: "What are you least sure about in that answer?"
Trusting facts without checking	AI tools can state wrong facts with confidence. Check numbers, names, dates, laws and anything about health or money against a real source.
Asking five things at once	One prompt, one job. Then the next.

The Friday 10 minutes

Once a week, run three prompts. It takes about ten minutes.

1 One decision you made: prompt 01

2 One thing you wrote: prompt 11

3 One thing you learned: prompt 17

Write your own

Take anything you are working on and add one of these endings.

- "...Argue against it."
- "...List what I am assuming."
- "...Tell me which you would choose and why."
- "...Ask me the questions I have not answered."

Thank you for your review. Your answers go into the community survey report. Everyone who filled in the form gets the report by email when the survey closes.

About Agentwise

Agentwise makes prompt toolkits and templates for one-person businesses. The free 7-prompt sample is at getagentwise.vercel.app. Questions: agentwise.hello@gmail.com.

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